

August 12, 2026

Molina Healthcare of South Carolina
Provider Appeals Department

RE: Formal Appeal of Claim Denial — Oretha Langworth (MRN MUSC3077563), Claim MUSC-20260517-FDBA-2

Patient	Oretha Langworth (DOB 1926-06-06)
MRN	MUSC3077563
Member ID / Group	MOL620059768 / GRP-33335
Claim number	MUSC-20260517-FDBA-2
Date of service	2026-05-17
Procedure billed	CPT 99214 — Office/outpatient visit, established patient, moderate complexity
Primary diagnosis	J06.9 — Acute upper respiratory infection, unspecified
Denied amount	\$404.47
Denial code	CARC 197 / RARC N54 — Precertification/authorization/notification/pre-treatment absent.
Appeal deadline	2026-09-21

Dear Appeals Review Committee:

SUMMARY OF APPEAL

MUSC Health Florence Medical Center submits this formal first-level appeal on behalf of patient Oretha Langworth (Member ID: MOL620059768) regarding the denial of Claim MUSC-20260517-FDBA-2 for services rendered on May 17, 2026, by Elena V. Castellanos, MD (NPI 1881726354). The claim was denied on June 23, 2026, under CARC 197 ("Precertification/authorization/notification/pre-treatment absent") and RARC N54 ("Claim information is inconsistent with pre-certified/authorized services"), with the payer remark stating: "No prior authorization on file for the date of service billed." MUSC Health respectfully disputes this denial and requests full reimbursement of the billed amount of \$404.47 for CPT 99214, an established-patient outpatient evaluation and management visit of moderate complexity.

CLINICAL BACKGROUND

Ms. Langworth is a 100-year-old female patient with active, complex chronic conditions including epilepsy and seizure disorder (G40.909, with onset documented from birth) and prediabetes (E11.9), in addition to a history of Alzheimer's disease. She presented on May 17, 2026, at MUSC Health Florence Medical Center (Place of Service 22, On Campus Outpatient Hospital) for an established-patient office visit. The primary diagnosis assigned was J06.9 (Acute upper respiratory infection, unspecified), with a secondary diagnosis of G40.909 reflecting her ongoing seizure disorder. Given Ms. Langworth's age and the complexity of her active comorbidities, the level of medical decision-making supporting a 99214 designation is consistent with the clinical picture documented in the encounter record.

BASIS FOR APPEAL

The denial rests solely on an assertion that no prior authorization was on file for the date of service. MUSC Health contends that prior authorization was either not required for this service under the applicable Molina Healthcare of South Carolina Medicaid MCO benefit plan (coverage period January 1, 2024, through December 31, 2026), or that any authorization requirement was satisfied at the time of service. Established-patient evaluation and management visits, particularly those conducted in an outpatient hospital setting for a patient with longstanding, documented chronic conditions, are a standard, medically necessary component of ongoing care. Payers participating in South Carolina Medicaid managed care are generally prohibited from imposing prior authorization requirements that create barriers to medically necessary outpatient follow-up care for patients with active chronic conditions, consistent with CMS managed care access and continuity-of-care standards.

Furthermore, RARC N54 indicates that claim information is inconsistent with pre-certified or authorized services, which presupposes that some authorization existed but was mismatched. MUSC Health requests that Molina Healthcare clarify whether any authorization record exists for this member and date of service, as the combination of CARC 197 and RARC N54 presents an internally inconsistent denial rationale. If an authorization was on file but coded to a different service or date, MUSC Health requests that Molina apply that authorization appropriately or advise on the correct corrective action. If no authorization was required for this service category under the plan's current prior authorization list, the denial should be reversed on that basis alone.

REQUESTED ACTION

MUSC Health respectfully requests that Molina Healthcare of South Carolina overturn the denial of Claim MUSC-20260517-FDBA-2 and issue payment at the allowed amount of \$238.02, or at the contractually applicable rate, for CPT 99214 rendered on May 17, 2026. In the alternative, MUSC Health requests that Molina Healthcare provide written documentation identifying the specific prior authorization requirement applicable to this service under the current plan benefit structure, along with any authorization number on file for this member, so that any administrative deficiency may be promptly remedied. This appeal is submitted within the 90-day appeal deadline of September 21, 2026, as specified on the remittance advice.

Respectfully submitted,

Angela R. Whitfield, RN, BSN, CPC

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Enclosures

- Remittance advice / explanation of payment
- Itemized claim detail (UB-04 / CMS-1500)
- Relevant clinical documentation from the medical record